

# PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Information Security Engineer | SIEM and Cloud Threat Lead | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | CISSP

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

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I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Information Security Engineer with over five years of experience leading threat detection, incident response, and security architecture efforts across hybrid on-premise and cloud environments. I have deep hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I have led the implementation and tuning of SIEM platforms, built custom detection rules and KQL queries, designed and automated incident response playbooks, and conducted proactive threat hunting across enterprise environments. I work effectively across cloud and on-premise security tooling and collaborate with infrastructure, architecture, and operational teams to strengthen detection capabilities and reduce organisational risk. I bring the same rigour and urgency to security operations within a high-profile, dynamic organisation as I do to any critical environment.

## CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

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- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel -- leading implementation, tuning, KQL detection rule development, workbook design, custom analytics
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** advanced threat hunting queries, custom detection rules, analytics rule development, workbooks
- **Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR):** Logic Apps playbooks, PowerShell automation, automated incident workflows
- **Threat Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned threat hunts, hypothesis-driven investigation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM, Spotlight) -- Expert
- **Microsoft 365 Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender (M365)
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security controls, Entra ID governance, cloud identity hardening, cloud access monitoring
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Network Security:** Firewall management (Check Point Harmony), Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS), network access control, segmentation
- **Windows and Linux Security:** endpoint hardening, secure configuration, Group Policy
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework, MITRE ATT&CK, containment and eradication
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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**Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer -- University of the Arts, London (UAL)** *March 2025 -- Present*

- Led the implementation, tuning, and ongoing management of Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, including building Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules, creating custom analytics rules, designing workbooks, and engineering automated response playbooks using Logic Apps to accelerate incident response.
- Delivered proactive threat hunting across the enterprise using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, applying MITRE ATT&CK threat intelligence to identify threats that evaded automated detections.

- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM) across the enterprise, tuning detection policies, managing alert triage, and driving improvements in EDR detection fidelity.
- Engineered SOAR automation playbooks using Logic Apps and PowerShell to automate repetitive triage, enrichment, and containment tasks, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) to security incidents.
- Secured cloud environments via Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and cloud access governance, hardening the organisation's cloud identity posture.
- Administered Windows security hardening through Group Policy and endpoint compliance policies, maintaining secure configuration baselines across the enterprise estate.
- Led incident response activities using the NIST 800-61 framework across a diverse hybrid environment, managing investigation, containment, eradication, and post-incident lessons learned.
- Oversaw Privileged Access Management (PAM) using BeyondTrust, enforcing least-privilege principles and securing privileged account access across on-premise and cloud systems.
- Managed vulnerability management operations using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), running regular assessments and coordinating cross-team remediation of critical findings.
- Maintained Mimecast email security controls and Check Point Harmony firewall management, defending the perimeter against phishing, malware, and network-based threats.

#### **Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity -- University of the Arts, London (UAL)**

*March 2022 -- March 2025*

- Built and matured Microsoft Sentinel SIEM capabilities by developing custom KQL detection rules, investigating security alerts, and automating incident workflows, improving the team's detection and response effectiveness across the enterprise.
- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, onboarding devices, configuring security policies, and managing the investigation and remediation of endpoint security alerts.
- Conducted threat hunting in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight using MITRE ATT&CK-aligned techniques, identifying adversary activity before it escalated to confirmed incidents.
- Designed and implemented SOAR automation using PowerShell scripting, creating repeatable workflows that reduced manual effort in alert triage and containment tasks.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) deployment, protecting identity across the enterprise and reducing the risk of credential-based compromise.
- Supported BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) implementation, onboarding privileged accounts and enforcing least-privilege access principles aligned with CIS Controls.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, delivering risk-prioritised remediation reports to infrastructure and application teams.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification, evidencing controls across endpoint protection, identity management, network boundary security, and patch management domains.

#### **IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure -- HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)**

*February 2021 -- March 2022*

- Managed security infrastructure and controls for a SaaS/FinTech environment, including firewall administration, endpoint security, identity management, and vulnerability remediation.
- Implemented Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) for a remote-first workforce, strengthening identity security and access control across the organisation.
- Administered Linux and Windows systems with a focus on secure configuration and hardening, maintaining security baselines across the server and endpoint estate.
- Conducted internal vulnerability assessments and supported external penetration test remediation, coordinating cross-functional remediation of identified security weaknesses.
- Maintained security policies and documentation aligned with ISO 27001 and operational security best practices in a fast-paced SaaS environment.

### **KEY ACHIEVEMENTS**

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- Led Microsoft Sentinel SIEM implementation and tuning at UAL, building KQL-based detection rules, custom analytics, and Logic Apps playbooks that measurably improved threat detection quality and response speed.
- Delivered enterprise CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment and ongoing management, enabling advanced endpoint protection, proactive threat hunting, and real-time detection across the university estate.
- Led Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment across 8,000 users, creating a mature and unified endpoint detection and response capability for the organisation.
- Built SOAR automation workflows using PowerShell and Logic Apps, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and freeing analyst capacity from repetitive triage tasks.
- Deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), significantly reducing the privileged account attack surface and enforcing least-privilege access organisation-wide.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating compliance with the UK government's cyber security framework across all five key control domains.

## EDUCATION

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- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

## CERTIFICATIONS

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- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

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References available on request | Hybrid (Manchester/North West England, UK)